

Construction and Architecture English Participant Workbook

Practice pages for realistic field-specific meetings, pushback, documentation, and role-play preparation

Audience: architects, construction managers, project engineers, site supervisors, estimators, owners' representatives, subcontractor coordinators, and design-build teams

Focus: A construction and architecture English curriculum for design intent, RFIs, change orders, site coordination, safety, schedule pressure, permitting, punch lists, claims, and client communication.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

How to Use This Workbook

For each module, read a workplace scenario and complete a bounded dialogue. Choose one of four options, then use the answer key to see why the selected phrase fits the evidence, risk, owner, and next step.

Module 1. Design Intent and Client Requirements

Situation

A client requests a major design change late in design development.

Stakeholder pressure: Update the drawings immediately.

Constraint: Scope, fee, schedule, code, and constructability implications need review.

Terms to use

- design intent
- program
- constructability
- scope

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A client requests a major design change late in design development.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Update the drawings immediately.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects program.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a design-change response.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects program.

Option	Phrase
A	scope
B	evidence threshold
C	design intent
D	constructability

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Update the drawings immediately.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve design intent after the result is visible.
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify design intent and program against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A client requests a major design change late in design development. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the design-change response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	operating constraint
D	decision owner

Module 2. Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs

Situation

A subcontractor says drawings conflict with specifications.

Stakeholder pressure: Tell them to follow the drawings.

Constraint: Contract documents, RFI process, schedule impact, and design response are needed.

Terms to use

- RFI
- specification
- drawing set
- submittal

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A subcontractor says drawings conflict with specifications.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Tell them to follow the drawings.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects specification.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a RFI response summary.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects specification.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	RFI
C	drawing set
D	submittal

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Tell them to follow the drawings.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	A RFI response summary is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
B	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify RFI and specification against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	We should act now and resolve RFI after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A subcontractor says drawings conflict with specifications. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the RFI response summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 3. Change Orders and Cost Control

Situation

A subcontractor submits a change order for hidden conditions.

Stakeholder pressure: Reject it because the budget is tight.

Constraint: Contract terms, notice, evidence, schedule, and pricing must be reviewed.

Terms to use

- change order
- allowance
- contingency

- notice

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A subcontractor submits a change order for hidden conditions.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Reject it because the budget is tight.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects allowance.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a change-order evaluation.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects allowance.

Option	Phrase
A	change order
B	contingency
C	notice
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Reject it because the budget is tight.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	We should act now and resolve change order after the result is visible.
B	A change-order evaluation is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify change order and allowance against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	decision owner

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A subcontractor submits a change order for hidden conditions. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Option	Phrase
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the change-order evaluation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 4. Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path

Situation

Steel delivery delay threatens enclosure work.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask all trades to recover the time.

Constraint: Critical path, float, resequencing, crew availability, and weather risk matter.

Terms to use

- critical path
- float
- lookahead schedule
- resequencing

Three-step decision practice

Situation

Steel delivery delay threatens enclosure work.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask all trades to recover the time.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects float.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a schedule impact update.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects float.

Option	Phrase
A	resequencing
B	evidence threshold
C	critical path
D	lookahead schedule

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask all trades to recover the time.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify critical path and float against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	decision owner
C	We should act now and resolve critical path after the result is visible.
D	A schedule impact update is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - Steel delivery delay threatens enclosure work. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the schedule impact update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
D	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.

Module 5. Site Safety and Toolbox Talks

Situation

A crew works at height without proper fall protection.

Stakeholder pressure: Remind them quickly and continue.

Constraint: Safety requirements, stop-work authority, training, and documentation apply.

Terms to use

- PPE
- fall protection
- toolbox talk
- stop work

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A crew works at height without proper fall protection.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Remind them quickly and continue.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects fall protection.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a toolbox safety talk.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects fall protection.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	PPE
C	toolbox talk
D	stop work

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Remind them quickly and continue.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify PPE and fall protection against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	We should act now and resolve PPE after the result is visible.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A crew works at height without proper fall protection. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
B	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the toolbox safety talk with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 6. Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues

Situation

An inspector rejects an installation detail.

Stakeholder pressure: Ask the inspector to be flexible.

Constraint: Code interpretation, approved drawings, corrective work, and reinspection are required.

Terms to use

- permit
- inspection
- code compliance

- reinspection

Three-step decision practice

Situation

An inspector rejects an installation detail.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Ask the inspector to be flexible.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects inspection.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a inspection correction plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects inspection.

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	permit

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Ask the inspector to be flexible.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	I understand the urgency. I need to verify permit and inspection against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
B	We should act now and resolve permit after the result is visible.
C	A inspection correction plan is unnecessary; verbal assurance should be enough.
D	I disagree, but I cannot name the boundary or the decision the group needs to make.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - An inspector rejects an installation detail. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the inspection correction plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
C	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Option	Phrase
D	evidence threshold

Module 7. Quality, Punch List, and Closeout

Situation

The client wants occupancy while punch items remain.

Stakeholder pressure: Hand over the space anyway.

Constraint: Life safety, substantial completion, warranties, and closeout documents need clarity.

Terms to use

- punch list
- substantial completion
- warranty
- closeout

Three-step decision practice

Situation

The client wants occupancy while punch items remain.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Hand over the space anyway.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects substantial completion.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a punch-list closeout plan.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects substantial completion.

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	punch list
D	evidence threshold

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Hand over the space anyway.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	operating constraint

Option	Phrase
B	decision owner
C	I understand the urgency. I need to verify punch list and substantial completion against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.
D	approval path

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - The client wants occupancy while punch items remain. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	evidence threshold
B	approval path
C	operating constraint
D	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the punch-list closeout plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.

Module 8. Claims, Disputes, and Documentation

Situation

A delay dispute emerges after months of informal changes.

Stakeholder pressure: Argue from memory.

Constraint: Daily reports, notices, photos, meeting minutes, and contract language matter.

Terms to use

- claim
- daily report
- meeting minutes
- entitlement

Three-step decision practice

Situation

A delay dispute emerges after months of informal changes.

Speaker	Line
Stakeholder	Argue from memory.
ESL learner	Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects daily report.
Stakeholder	What would let us move forward responsibly?
ESL learner	I will test the constraint with the decision owner and return with a claim chronology.

1. Complete the field language

Choose the term that belongs in this decision point.

Before we act, I need to confirm the _____ and how it affects daily report.

Option	Phrase
A	decision owner
B	daily report
C	meeting minutes
D	claim

2. Choose the strongest professional response

Select the response that preserves the relationship while setting an evidence-based boundary.

A stakeholder says, 'Argue from memory.' Which response gives a useful, professional form of pushback?

Option	Phrase
A	approval path
B	operating constraint
C	decision owner
D	I understand the urgency. I need to verify claim and daily report against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.

3. Select the next decision move

Choose the action that turns the discussion into a controlled workplace decision.

Given this situation - A delay dispute emerges after months of informal changes. - what should happen next?

Option	Phrase
A	Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the claim chronology with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.
B	Accept the request immediately because the stakeholder has already expressed urgency.
C	Send every available detail to senior leaders without identifying the decision they need to make.
D	Wait for the problem to become visible before assigning an owner or evidence source.

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each stage after completing the practice sequence. The rationale explains the decision skill the strongest response demonstrates.

Design Intent and Client Requirements - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. design intent	'design intent' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Design Intent and Client Requirements - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify design intent and program against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Design Intent and Client Requirements - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the design-change response with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. RFI	'RFI' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify RFI and specification against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Drawings, Specifications, and RFIs - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the RFI response summary with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Change Orders and Cost Control - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. change order	'change order' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Change Orders and Cost Control - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify change order and allowance against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Change Orders and Cost Control - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the change-order evaluation with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. critical path	'critical path' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify critical path and float against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Schedule, Sequencing, and Critical Path - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the schedule impact update with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Site Safety and Toolbox Talks - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. PPE	'PPE' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Site Safety and Toolbox Talks - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify PPE and fall protection against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Site Safety and Toolbox Talks - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the toolbox safety talk with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. permit	'permit' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. I understand the urgency. I need to verify permit and inspection against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Permitting, Inspections, and Code Issues - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the inspection correction plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Quality, Punch List, and Closeout - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. punch list	'punch list' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Quality, Punch List, and Closeout - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. I understand the urgency. I need to verify punch list and substantial completion against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Quality, Punch List, and Closeout - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the punch-list closeout plan with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.

Claims, Disputes, and Documentation - 1. Complete the field language

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. claim	'claim' is the field-specific variable that must be checked before the team can proceed responsibly. This is the decision variable the learner must confirm before the team acts.

Claims, Disputes, and Documentation - 2. Choose the strongest professional response

Correct answer	Why it fits
D. I understand the urgency. I need to verify claim and daily report against the stated constraint before I recommend the next step.	The strongest response names the field terms, the constraint, and the condition for a recommendation without sounding defensive or passive. This response is specific, respectful, and appropriately conditional. It converts pressure into a controlled decision.

Claims, Disputes, and Documentation - 3. Select the next decision move

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. Review the stated constraint with the accountable owner, then prepare the claim chronology with the evidence, tradeoff, and requested decision.	The best next move makes the evidence, tradeoff, owner, and requested decision visible in a concise workplace artifact. This sequence creates a concise, decision-ready artifact with a clear owner and evidence boundary.